

WORKING IN CASELIGHT

User Guide

A screen-by-screen walkthrough for staff — individuals, households, programs, assessments, case notes, and the calendar.

Lighthouse Nonprofit Technologies · CaseLight · AGPL-3.0 — screens show synthetic demo data only



CaseLight — User Guide

CaseLight is a case-management system for frontline human-services nonprofits. It tracks the people you serve, the households they belong to, the programs they move through, and the assessments and notes that record how the work is going — with security controls usually reserved for far more expensive software.

This guide walks through the app the way staff actually use it, role by role and screen by screen.

If you cannot see a feature this guide describes, it is probably not missing — your role's permissions may not include it. Ask your administrator before assuming something is broken.

All screenshots in this guide show synthetic demo data — fictional names, addresses, and records generated for demonstration. No real client information appears anywhere.

Printable editions: polished PDFs live in [docs/pdf/](#) — [User Guide](#), [Administrator Guide](#), and a [Brochure](#).

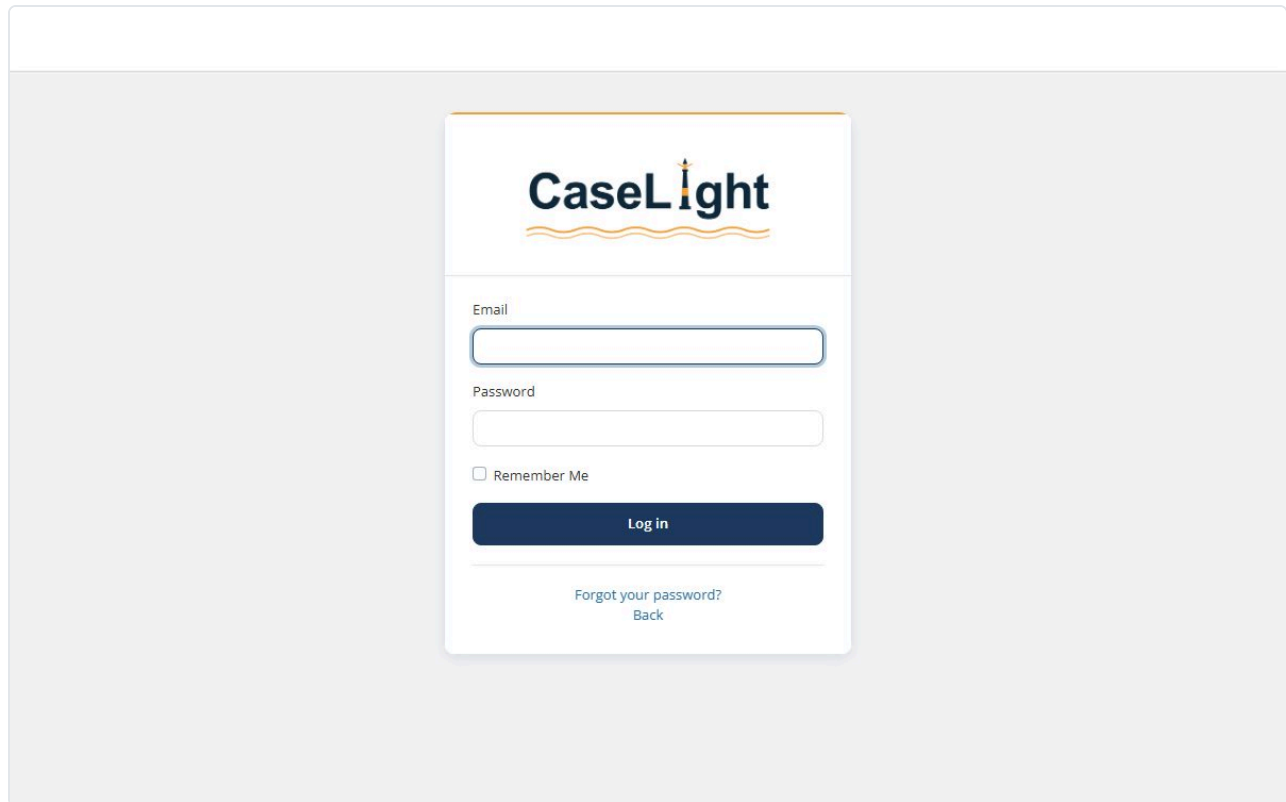
Contents

1. [Signing in](#)
2. [Protecting your account](#)
3. [Roles at a glance](#)
4. [Your first week](#)
5. [The dashboard](#)
6. [Finding people: individuals, households & search](#)
7. [The household record](#)
8. [The individual record](#)
9. [Programs & enrollments](#)
10. [Case notes](#)
11. [Assessments & domains](#)
12. [Tasks & notifications](#)
13. [The calendar](#)
14. [Custom forms — the form builder \(administrators\)](#)
15. [Security & administration \(administrators\)](#)
16. [Data protection & privacy](#)
17. [Change history](#)

18. [Administration reference — the Manage menu](#)
19. [Troubleshooting & FAQ](#)
20. [Glossary](#)

Reading paths. Case workers: read §1–§13 — that is the day-to-day toolset. Managers: add §12 (the notifications and active-task views are your supervision tools) and §17. Administrators: this whole guide plus the [Administrator Guide](#), which covers configuration in depth.

1. Signing in

The image shows a login form for CaseLight. At the top is the CaseLight logo, which consists of the word "CaseLight" in a dark blue sans-serif font, with a small orange flame icon above the "i" and three wavy orange lines below the text. Below the logo are two input fields: "Email" and "Password". The "Email" field has a blue border and a small blue eye icon on the right. The "Password" field has a grey border and a small grey eye icon on the right. Below the password field is a checkbox labeled "Remember Me". At the bottom of the form is a dark blue button with the text "Log in" in white. Below the button is a link that says "Forgot your password?" with a "Back" link underneath it.

Each staff member has their own account — one person per login, so the audit history is meaningful. Sign in with your email and password. CaseLight supports two additional protections:

- **Multi-factor authentication (MFA)** — a time-based one-time code from an authenticator app, with one-time recovery codes.
- **Passkeys** — phishing-resistant WebAuthn sign-in (Face ID / Touch ID / a security key), via the **"Sign in with a passkey"** button.

Administrators can require MFA for privileged roles. Repeated failed sign-ins lock an account temporarily; it unlocks automatically after a set interval. If your organization has password expiry enabled, CaseLight will route you to a change-password screen when your password ages out — that is expected, not an error.

2. Protecting your account

Both protections are self-service — open the **profile menu** (your name, bottom of the sidebar):

- **Two-factor authentication** — scan the QR code with any authenticator app (1Password, Google Authenticator, Authy...), confirm a code, and **save your recovery codes** somewhere safe. Each recovery code works once, for a day you don't have your phone; you can regenerate the set at any time (which invalidates the old ones).
- **Passkeys** — register the device you actually work on (laptop fingerprint reader, phone, hardware key). You can register several and remove any of them later.

Choose a strong, unique password. It isn't just your account you're protecting — it's your clients' records.

3. Roles at a glance

CaseLight shows the **same records** to everyone who's authorized, but presents them in the way each role works — and limits what lower-privilege roles can see.

Role	Sees	Individuals view
Administrator	Everything; manages users, forms, programs, and security	Dense table
Strategic overviewer	Read-only overview across the organization (standard-sensitivity data)	Dense table
Manager	The caseloads of the case workers they manage	Cards
Case worker	The clients assigned to them, plus those clients' households	Cards
Specialized managers (EC / FC / KC / Able)	Program-specific management	Cards

Sensitive fields are additionally gated by **field-level sensitivity** (see [§16](#)) — a role that can open a record still won't see fields marked above its clearance.

4. Your first week

The day-one path, in order:

1. **Sign in** with the credentials your administrator created ([§1](#)).
2. **Enroll MFA and save your recovery codes** ([§2](#)) — do this before anything else.
3. **Open Individuals** — the cards you see are your caseload ([§6](#)).
4. **Open one person's record** and read the Overview top to bottom; check their household's **Alerts** tab for anything marked "read first" ([§7](#), [§8](#)).
5. **Log your first case note** after your first contact ([§10](#)).
6. **Set a task** for your next follow-up, from the note itself or the calendar ([§12](#), [§13](#)).
7. **Watch the bell** — from now on, overdue work finds you ([§12](#)).

The rhythm of the work is a loop: **assess** → **plan** → **do the tasks** → **write it up in case notes** → **reassess**. Every tool in this guide serves one leg of that loop.

5. The dashboard

Your landing page depends on your role.

Case workers and managers get a personal dashboard: a greeting, four tiles that are yours alone — **My overdue tasks** (flagged when there's anything in it), **Due today**, **Next 7 days**, and **My caseload** — and a **7-day schedule** of the week ahead. Every day gets its own row — today is highlighted, timed tasks show their times, and a day with nothing scheduled says so, calmly — so the week always scans at a glance. Every tile and schedule line links straight to the work it names. If your day starts anywhere, it starts here.

CaseLight

Wes Worker
case worker

Dashboards

Individuals12

Households5

Manage

Welcome back, Wes

Your tasks and caseload for the week ahead.

5
MY OVERDUE TASKS

1
DUE TODAY

5
NEXT 7 DAYS

12
MY CASELOAD

Your next 7 days

TODAY
Jul 30

1:00 PM

ESL class drop-in

Layla Hassan

FRI
Jul 31

All day

Submit housing paperwork

Yusuf Hassan

SAT
Aug 1

All day

probe task

Chidi Okonkwo

All day

probe task 1 lrs4dpz19c

Chidi Okonkwo

SUN
Aug 2

All day

probe task 2 dph3k9ckejw

Chidi Okonkwo

MON
Aug 3

All day

probe task 3 it5j6l2dsk9

Chidi Okonkwo

TUE
Aug 4

NOTHING SCHEDULED

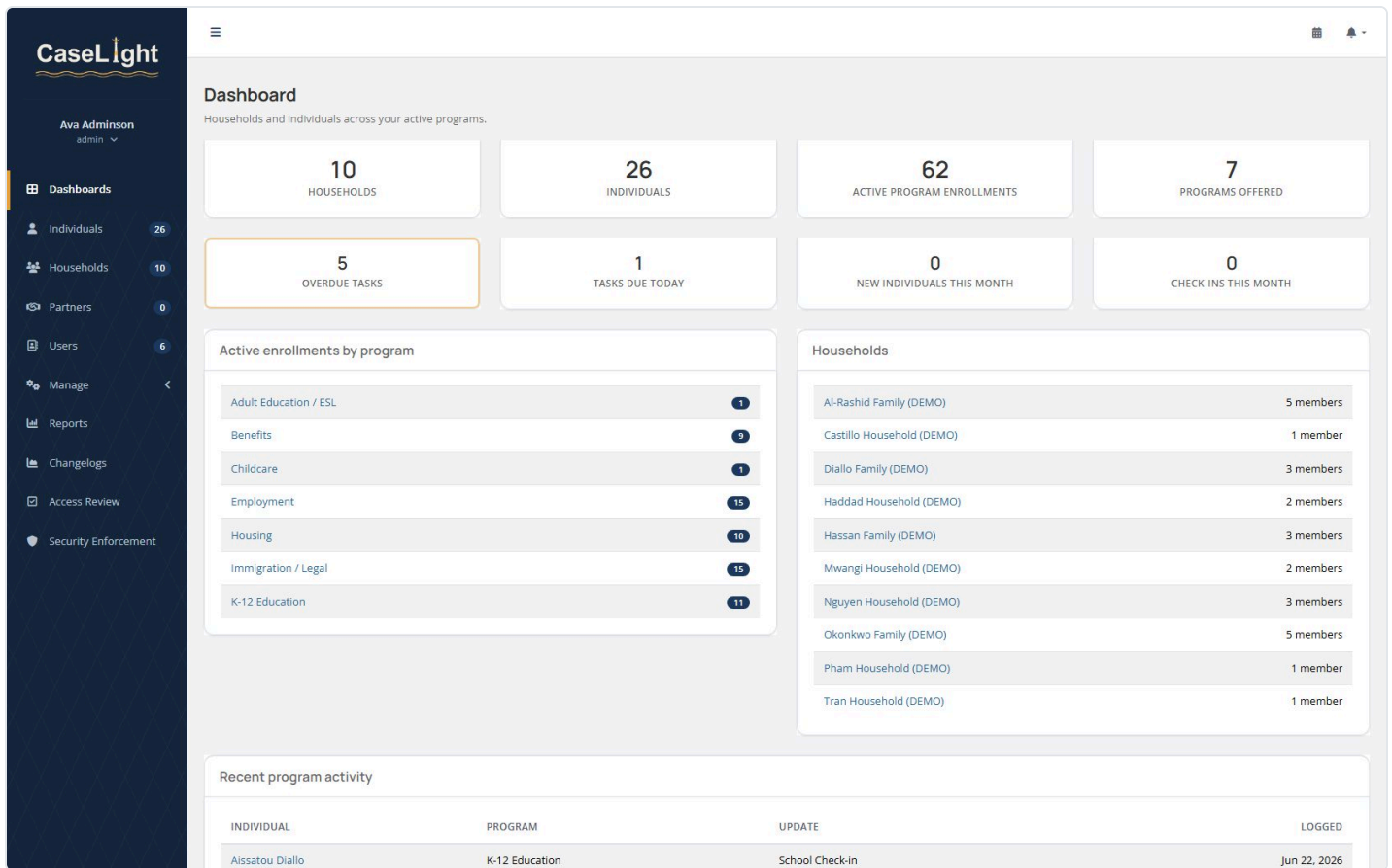
WED
Aug 5

NOTHING SCHEDULED

Administrators and strategic overviews get the organization dashboard, which summarizes the organization at a glance:

CaseLight — User Guide

Page 5 of 29



- **Headline counts** — households, individuals, active program enrollments, and programs offered.
- **Flash metrics** — overdue tasks, tasks due today, new individuals this month, and check-ins this month.
- **Active enrollments by program** — how many people are currently in Housing, Employment, Immigration/Legal, Education, Benefits, and so on.
- **Households** — every household with its member count, each a link into the record.
- **Recent program activity** — the latest dated updates across the caseload.

6. Finding people: individuals, households & search

Every person in CaseLight is an **individual**, and every individual belongs to a **household**. Households are listed under **Households**; individuals under **Individuals**.

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Dashboards

Individuals 26

Households 10

Partners 0

Users 6

Manage

Reports

Changelogs

Access Review

Security Enforcement

Households

Add New Household

10 Results

Sort by...

NAME	INDIVIDUALS
Al-Rashid Family (DEMO)	Khalid Al-Rashid Fatima Al-Rashid Omar Al-Rashid Yara Al-Rashid +1
Castillo Household (DEMO)	Rosa Castillo
Diallo Family (DEMO)	Mamadou Diallo Ibrahim Diallo Aissatou Diallo
Haddad Household (DEMO)	Sami Haddad Layal Haddad
Hassan Family (DEMO)	Yusuf Hassan Amina Hassan Layla Hassan
Mwangi Household (DEMO)	Joseph Mwangi Grace Mwangi
Nguyen Household (DEMO)	Linh Nguyen Duc Nguyen Kim Nguyen
Okonkwo Family (DEMO)	Emeka Okonkwo Ngozi Okonkwo Chidi Okonkwo Amara Okonkwo +1
Pham Household (DEMO)	Bao Pham
Tran Household (DEMO)	Minh Tran

Depending on your role, the **Individuals** list appears one of two ways:

Administrators & strategic overviews get a dense, sortable table — name, case manager, gender/age, status, and program-stream tags — with export and advanced search:

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Dashboards

Individuals 26

Households 10

Partners 0

Users 6

Manage

Reports

Changelogs

Access Review

Security Enforcement

Individuals

First or last name

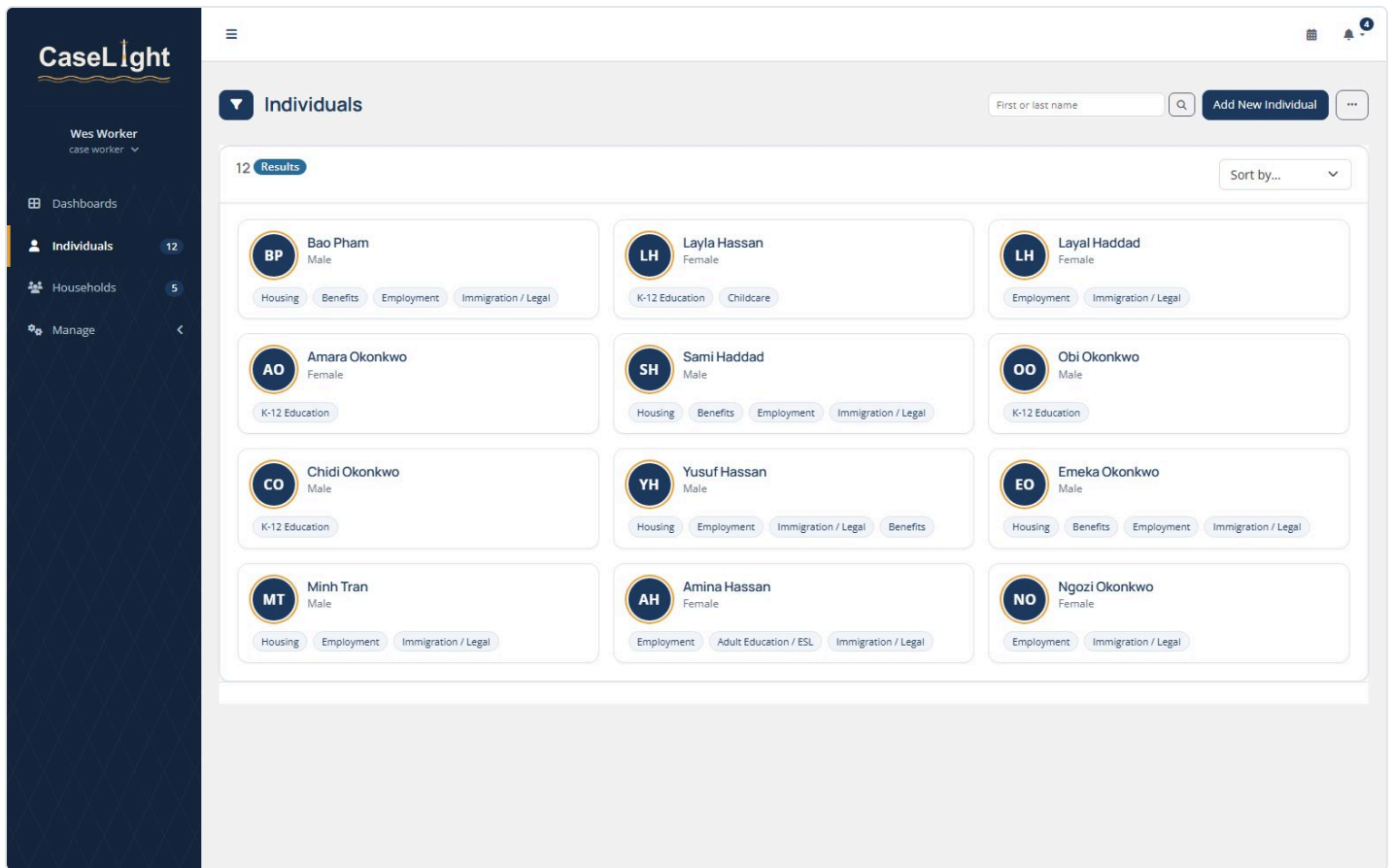
Add New Individual

26 Results

Sort by...

NAME	GENDER / AGE	PROGRAMS	CASE MANAGER
Yara Al-Rashid	Female · 12 yrs 7 mos	K-12 Education	Dev Admin
Bao Pham	Male · 70 yrs 11 mos	Housing · Benefits · Employment · Immigration / Legal	Wes Worker, Dev Admin
Linh Nguyen	Female · 38 yrs 4 mos	Housing · Benefits · Employment · Immigration / Legal	Dev Admin
Emeka Okonkwo	Male · 44 yrs 1 mo	Housing · Benefits · Employment · Immigration / Legal	Wes Worker, Dev Admin
Fatima Al-Rashid	Female · 40 yrs 1 mo	Employment · Immigration / Legal	Dev Admin
Layal Haddad	Female · 33 yrs 11 mos	Employment · Immigration / Legal	Wes Worker, Dev Admin
Khalid Al-Rashid	Male · 46 yrs 5 mos	Housing · Benefits · Employment · Immigration / Legal	Dev Admin
Duc Nguyen	Male · 13 yrs 9 mos	K-12 Education	Dev Admin
Amina Hassan	Female · 35 yrs 10 mos	Employment · Adult Education / ESL · Immigration / Legal	Wes Worker, Dev Admin
Kim Nguyen	Female · 11 yrs 2 mos	K-12 Education	Dev Admin
Joseph Mwangi	Male · 35 yrs 6 mos	Housing · Benefits · Employment · Immigration / Legal	Dev Admin
Grace Mwangi	Female · 31 yrs 10 mos	Employment · Immigration / Legal	Dev Admin
Rosa Castillo	Female · 68 yrs 9 mos	Housing · Benefits · Employment · Immigration / Legal	Dev Admin
Mamadou Diallo	Male · 43 yrs 0 mos	Housing · Benefits · Employment · Immigration / Legal	Dev Admin
Ibrahim Diallo	Male · 16 yrs 5 mos	K-12 Education	Dev Admin
Layla Hassan	Female · 11 yrs 6 mos	K-12 Education · Childcare	Wes Worker, Dev Admin

Managers & case workers get a card per person, scoped to the caseload they carry:



From either view the header offers:

- **Quick search by first or last name.** Type either name — `maria` , `Hassan` , or a full `Maria Gonzalez` — in any capitalization. It matches whole names (not fragments), so `mar` won't find Maria but `maria` will.
- A **Sort by...** menu — first name, last name, status, ID, age, or state, ascending or descending. Households sort by name, member count, or state.
- An **Add New Individual** button, and a "... menu with Reports, Advanced Search, View All Active Tasks, and the exports.

Active search filters show as dismissible **chips** under the header — click a chip's **x** to clear that filter. Click anywhere on a card (or a name in the list) to open the record; each card's program chips jump straight to that program.

Advanced Search (in the "... menu) is the report builder: pick the columns you care about — basic fields, custom-form fields, or program-stream fields — then stack filter rules on top and export the result to XLS. If a search returns nothing you expected to find, check the filter chips first: an over-narrow rule (two mutually exclusive conditions joined with AND) returns zero rows.

The Reports page. Administrators and directors get a **Reports** entry in the left menu (also linked from the Individuals page header). It gathers the organization-wide charts — assessment domain scores and case statistics — plus the data tools: Advanced Search with its Excel export. Per-vertical reporting will grow here.

7. The household record

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Dashboards

Individuals 26

Households 10

Partners 0

Users 6

Manage

Reports

Changelogs

Access Review

Security Enforcement

Al-Rashid Family (DEMO) Active

5 member(s)

Overview Forms 0 Notes 1 Alerts 1

Wellness concern — read before any home visit — Contact the case manager before visiting; see household notes. [View alerts](#)

About Family

CASE HISTORY SYNTHETIC DATA ONLY.	ADDRESS 521 Higuera St, San Luis Obispo, CA 93401	MEMBER COUNT 5 People	HOUSEHOLD NOTES Synthetic demo household.
HOUSEHOLD INCOME \$100.00	DEPENDABLE INCOME? No	FEMALE CHILDREN 1	MALE CHILDREN 2
FEMALE ADULTS 1	MALE ADULTS 1	CONTRACT DATE —	

5 Results

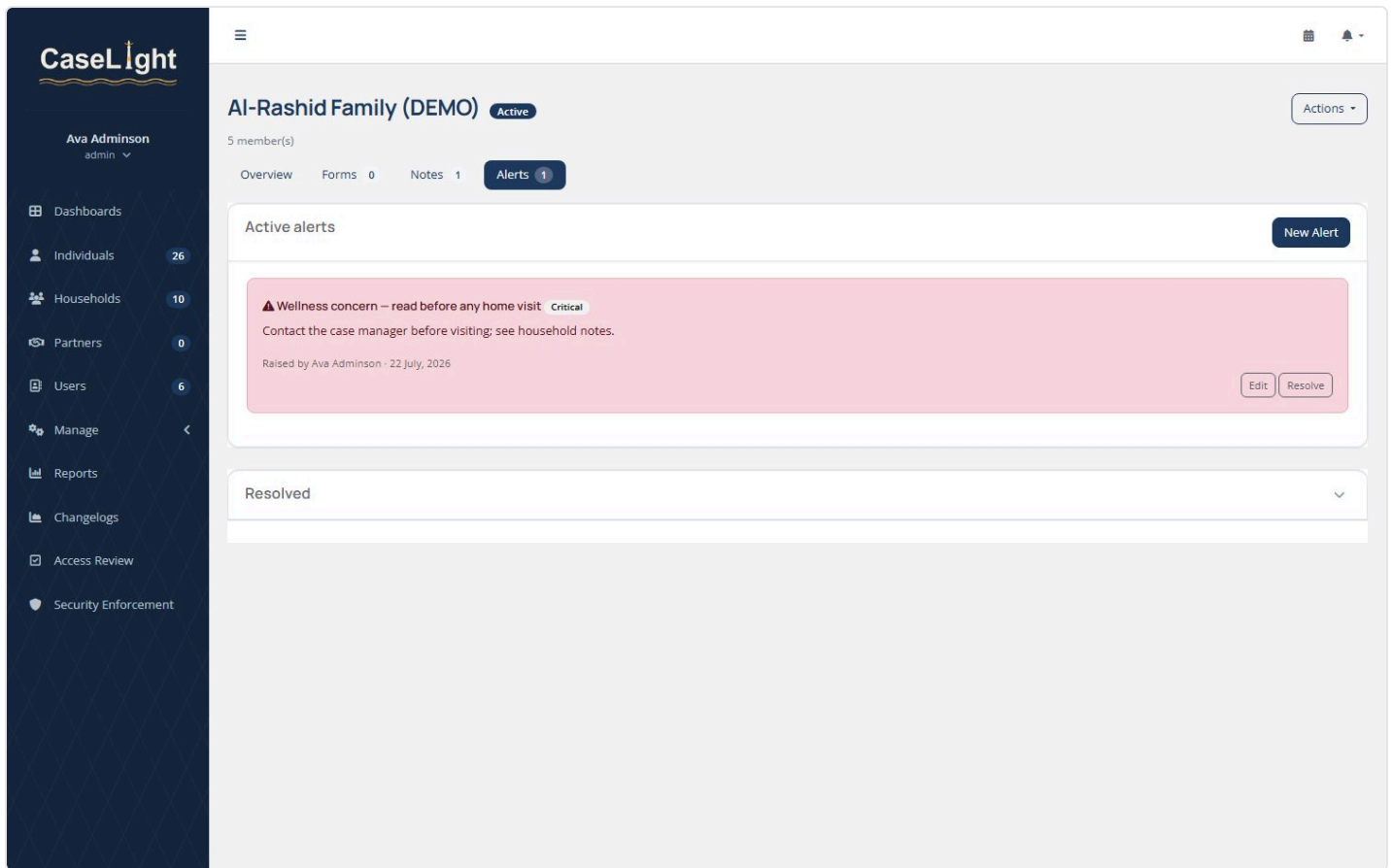
HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS

Khalid Al-Rashid Fatima Al-Rashid Omar Al-Rashid Yara Al-Rashid Tariq Al-Rashid

GIVEN NAME	FAMILY NAME	GENDER	STATUS	PROGRAMS	AGE	CASE MANAGER
Khalid	Al-Rashid	Male	Active	Housing, Benefits, Employment, Immigration / Legal	46 years 5 months	Dev Admin
Fatima	Al-Rashid	Female	Active	Employment, Immigration / Legal	40 years 1 month	Dev Admin
Omar	Al-Rashid	Male	Active	K-12 Education	15 years 3 months	Dev Admin
Yara	Al-Rashid	Female	Active	K-12 Education	12 years 7 months	Dev Admin
Tariq	Al-Rashid	Male	Active	K-12 Education	10 years 0 months	Dev Admin

Households have a full record of their own — the shared context that individual records hang off. The page keeps a persistent header — household name, type, status, and counts — with an **Actions** menu (edit, add form, new household note, new alert, delete) and four tabs:

- **Overview** — an About grid (case history, address, member count, income...), the **household members** list (each member links to their individual record) above a compact members table, and any custom-form panes.
- **Forms** — the household's filled custom forms, same layout as an individual's Forms tab ([§8](#)).
- **Notes** — **household notes**: the shared narrative that belongs to the whole household (a housing inspection, a home visit that involved everyone) rather than to one member's case file. Use an individual's case notes for casework about that person; use household notes for the home.
- **Alerts** — operational warnings the whole team must see before interacting with the household.



Household alerts are the "read this first" mechanism:

- An active alert shows as a **red banner at the top of the household's Overview** — nobody who opens the record can miss it.
- Every **member's individual record** shows a red **Household alert** badge in its header while any alert is active, so the warning follows the people.
- Alerts are **resolved, never deleted** — resolving one records who resolved it and when, and the history stays on the Alerts tab.

Case workers see the households of their own caseload — you can read the household record, read its alerts, and add household notes for the families you serve.

8. The individual record

The screenshot shows the CaseLight interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with the CaseLight logo and a navigation menu including Dashboards, Individuals (26), Households (10), Partners (0), Users (6), Manage, Reports, Changelogs, Access Review, and Security Enforcement. The main content area has a header for 'Yara Al-Rashid' with status 'Active' and a 'Household alert' badge. It also shows 'Female' and 'Date of Birth December 01, 2013 (12 years 7 months)'. There are 'Accept' and 'Reject' buttons. Below is an 'About Individual' section with a grid of details: HOUSEHOLDS, ADDRESS (521 Higuera St, San Luis Obispo, CA 93401), COUNTRY OF ORIGIN, SCHOOL NAME, SCHOOL GRADE (0), RELEVANT REFERRAL INFORMATION, CASE MANAGER (Dev Admin), AGENCIES INVOLVED, DONOR, REFERRAL SOURCE, CASE (Active), INTAKE DATE (22 June, 2026), and CASE HOUSEHOLD (Al-Rashid Family (DEMO)).

An individual's page brings the whole picture together under a persistent header — the person's name, status, date of birth, household, and (when relevant) a red **Household alert** badge — with an **Actions** menu and tabs that follow you across every sub-page:

- **Overview** — the **About** section first: one label-over-value grid holding the person's details *and* the case facts (intake date, case household, case status), with **Edit Case** and **Exit From Case** close to hand. The edit form's **gender picker offers the full California SOGI-style list** (including non-binary, transgender, questioning, another gender identity, and declined to state — blank simply means "not asked"), a **Quantitative data** section for the organization's reference lists (English proficiency, income range, benefits enrolled — single- or multi-select as each list allows), and an optional **contact email with a reminder-consent checkbox** — with consent recorded and the installation's email configured, the person gets a short appointment reminder the day before their tasks (never any case content — just a count and times). Below it: **Programs** and **recent program activity** panes, then **each filled custom form as its own collapsible section** — expand one to read the latest entries without leaving the page.
- **Programs** — one tab per program the person has ever been in, each holding that program's dates, check-ins, and actions, plus an **Add Program** picker ([§9](#)).
- **Forms** — every filled custom form in one table: the **form name opens its entries**, with entry count, latest-entry date, and an **Add entry** action beside it; the **Add new form** menu holds the forms not yet started. Forms marked **emergency-only** appear as locked rows: staff who qualify can **Request access** — a 1-hour, reason-required break-glass grant (the header shows a countdown chip while access is active).
- **Case Notes / Assessments / Tasks** — each one click away, with counts on the tabs.

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Yara Al-Rashid Active Household alert Actions

Female · Date of Birth December 01, 2013 (12 years 7 months)

Forms Add new form

FORM	ENTRIES	LATEST ENTRY	ACTIONS
Member: Wellness & Goals	1	22 June, 2026	Add entry

The **Actions** menu is the same everywhere in the record — you never have to hunt for the right tab to act. It gathers: Edit, the case actions (edit / exit the case, or open the active EC/FC/KC case), New Case Note, Add Form, New Assessment, New Task, progress notes, case history, and (for authorized roles) Delete.

Two small conveniences worth knowing: sections with nothing in them start **collapsed** — the chevron in a section's corner expands it; and the left menu collapses to an icon rail from the menu icon whenever you want the record at full width — your choice sticks, in both directions, until you toggle it again.

9. Programs & enrollments

Programs are enrollable services — each with its own custom form and recurring, date-stamped check-ins ("trackings"). Administrators define the programs the organization actually runs.

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Dashboards

Individuals 26

Households 10

Partners 0

Users 6

Manage

Agencies

Domains

Domain Groups

Donors

Referral Sources

Quantitative Types

Progress Note

Form Builder

Programs

What's New

Reports

Changelogs

Access Review

Programs

Add New Program

Our Programs

Program Library (other organizations)

NAME	DOMAINS	STATUS	ENROLLED	MAXIMUM PROGRAM ENROLLMENT	ACTION
Adult Education / ESL		Completed	1		View Edit Delete
Benefits		Completed	9		View Edit Delete
Childcare		Completed	1		View Edit Delete
Employment		Completed	15		View Edit Delete
Housing		Completed	10		View Edit Delete
Immigration / Legal		Completed	15		View Edit Delete
K-12 Education		Completed	11		View Edit Delete

On a person's **Programs** tab, every program they have ever been in gets **its own tab**: the enrollment date (and exit date, once exited), an **Add Tracking** action for the program's check-in forms, and the running timeline — enrollment, every check-in, and the exit, newest first, each with a **View** link into the full entry. **Add Program** opens the picker of programs with space available; programs that are full say so. Coming from a person's Overview, clicking a program name lands you directly on that program's tab.

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Dashboards

Individuals 26

Households 10

Partners 0

Users 6

Manage

Reports

Changelogs

Access Review

Security Enforcement

Yara Al-Rashid

Active

Household alert

Actions

Female · Date of Birth December 01, 2013 (12 years 7 months)

Programs

Add Program

K-12 Education

Active

Enrolled 08 January, 2025

Add Tracking

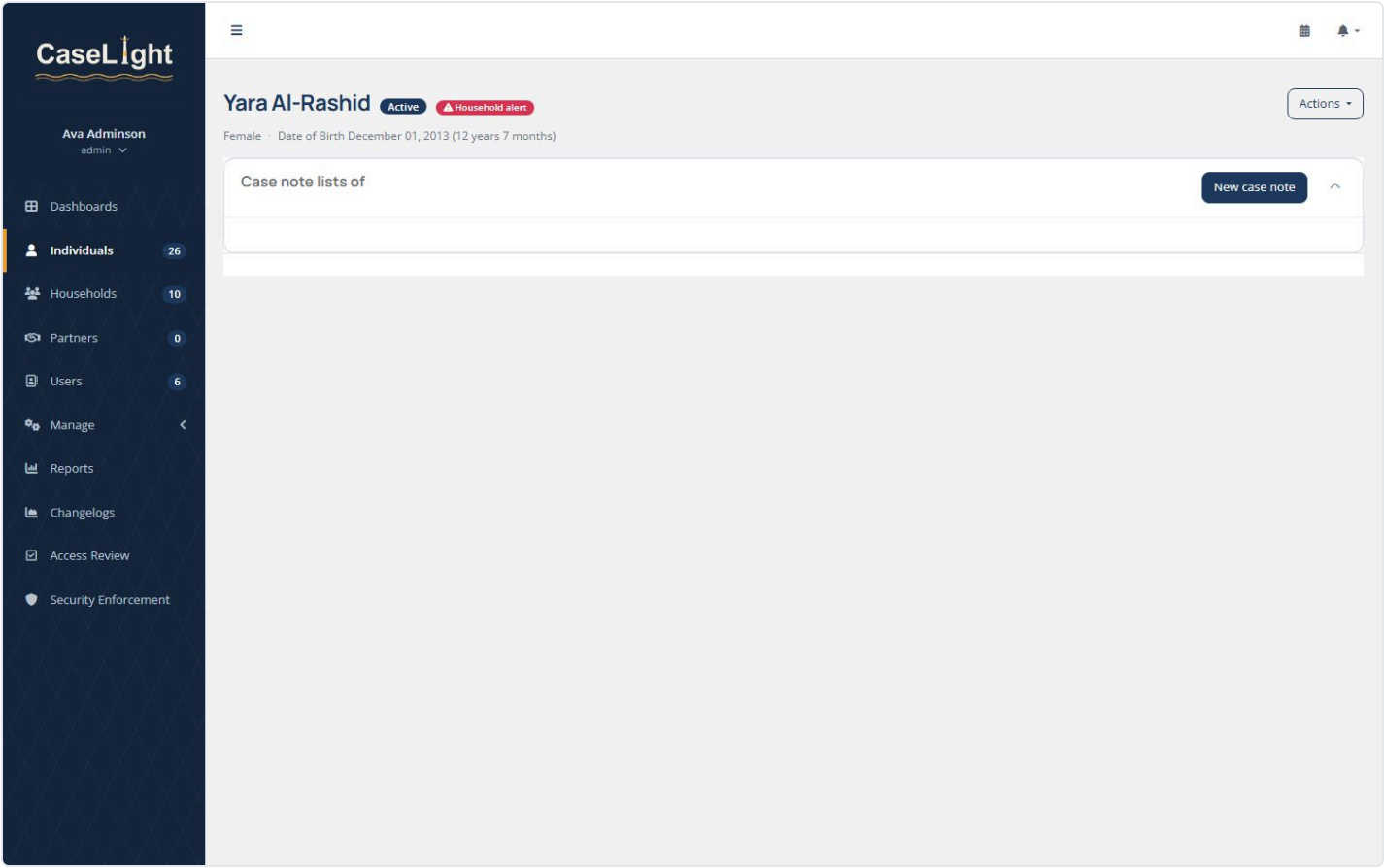
Exit Program

FORMS	DATE	ACTIONS
Tracking (School Check-in)	22 June, 2026	View
Enrollment	08 January, 2025	View

Leaving a program. When someone completes (or exits) a program, use the tab's **Exit Program** action — it captures the program's exit form with the leave date. Exited programs keep their tabs (with a **Re-enroll** action when the program allows it), and every tracking entry remains exportable per enrollment, so the record of the work survives the exit.

Tracking form or custom form? If the data belongs to a *program* — a recurring check-in that only makes sense while someone is enrolled — it's a tracking on that program. If it belongs to the *person or household* regardless of program (an intake document, a housing inspection), it's a custom form ([§14](#)). When in doubt: "would we still record this if they left the program?" — yes means custom form.

10. Case notes



Case notes are the running narrative of the work with a person — dated entries attached to the individual, visible to the staff authorized to see that record. A good case note is the handover document your colleague reads when they cover for you: objective, factual, respectful, and concise.

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Dashboards

Individuals 26

Households 10

Partners 0

Users 6

Manage

Reports

Changelogs

Access Review

Security Enforcement

Meeting detail

* On Date

* Who was there during the visit or conversation?

Domains discussed

Only the selected domains appear below and are saved.

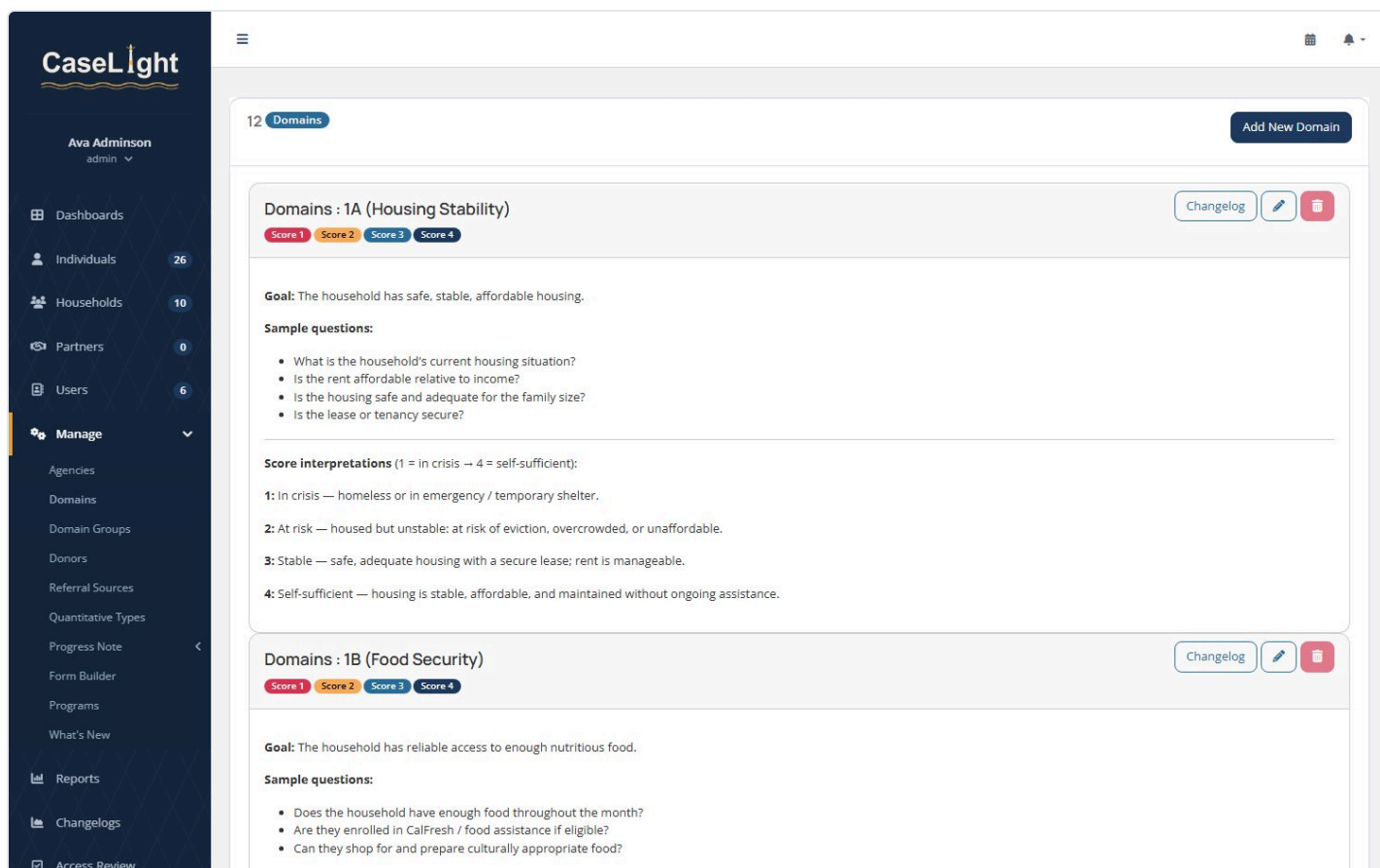
Save Back

Writing one (from the **Actions** menu or the Case Notes tab):

- Record the **meeting date** and **who was present**.
- Pick the **domains discussed** — only the domains you select appear on the form and are saved, so a quick housing check-in is a short form, not a scroll past every domain the organization tracks.
- **Attach files** where the paper trail matters (a signed form, a notice) — attachments are stored against the note and download through the same authorization checks as the record.
- **Add follow-up tasks** right inside the note — the "what's next" of the visit becomes a dated task without leaving the page.

11. Assessments & domains

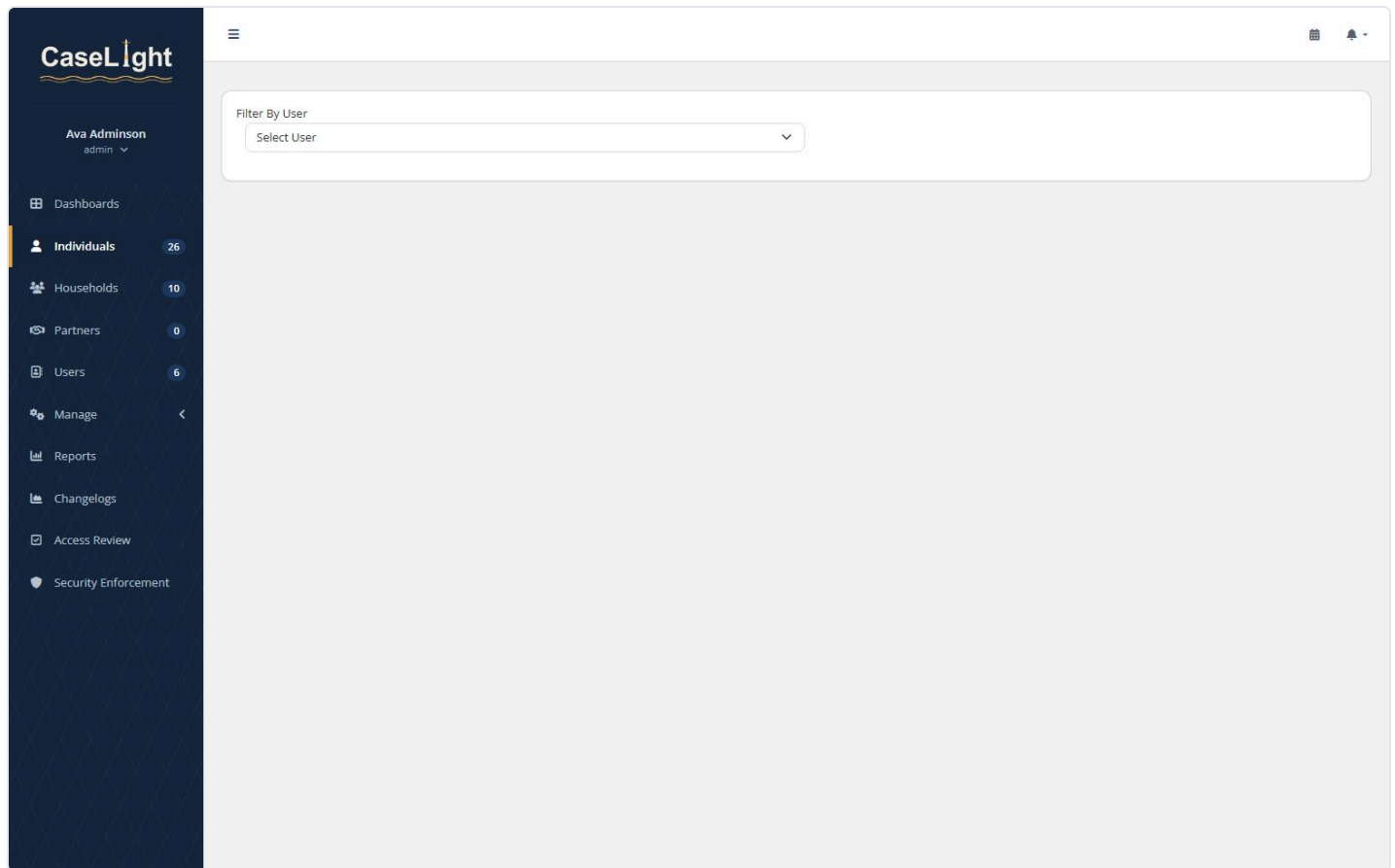
CaseLight includes a structured **assessment** engine: periodic, scored needs assessments across **life domains** (for example Health, Mental Health, Immigration Status, Personal Safety, Education). Administrators configure the domains and their scoring under **Manage** → **Domains**.



Running one: start it from the Assessments tab (or **Actions** → **New Assessment**), work through each domain — score, observations, any attachments — and save. Repeating the assessment at the cadence your organization sets is what turns scores into a *trajectory*: the domain-by-domain picture of whether things are improving. Assessments that come due appear in the notification bell ([§12](#)).

Each domain can be marked with a **sensitivity level**, so the most protected domains (for example Mental Health or Immigration Status) are only visible to appropriately cleared roles.

12. Tasks & notifications



Tasks are how follow-ups survive a busy week. There are three ways to create one, and all three produce the same thing — a dated task attached to a person (and optionally a program and domain):

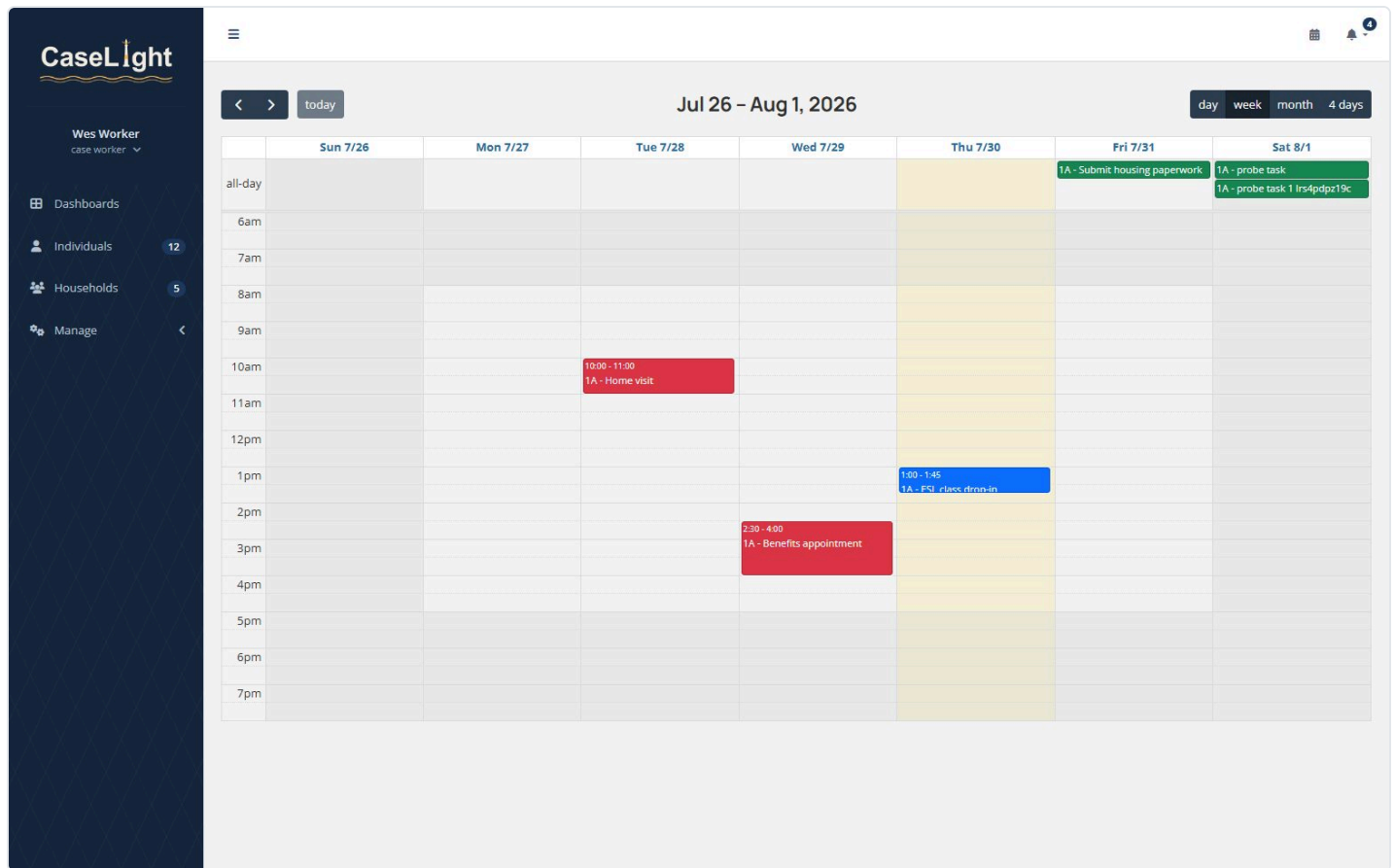
1. From a person's **Tasks tab** (or **Actions** → **New Task**).
2. By **clicking a day — or an hour slot — on the calendar** ([§13](#)).
3. **Inside a case note**, as the follow-up to the visit you're writing up ([§10](#)).

A task can be **all-day** (just a date — the default) or **timed**: give it a start time and a duration and it becomes an hour block on the calendar's week and day views. Use timed tasks for anything that occupies part of a day — a home visit at 2:00, a benefits appointment at 9:30 — and all-day tasks for deadlines.

View All Active Tasks (in the Individuals "... " menu) shows your whole task load grouped by urgency — overdue, due today, upcoming — person by person. Managers can filter it by case worker, which makes it the supervision view: where is the backlog, who needs help this week.

The **bell** in the top bar is the same information pushed to you: overdue and due-today tasks, assessments coming due, custom forms whose frequency says they're due again, program trackings due, and exit-window reminders. Each line links to a pre-filtered list. If the bell shows a number, that's the day's real to-do list.

13. The calendar



The calendar is your caseload's tasks, live — it opens on the **week view**, with day, 4-day, and month views a click away. Timed tasks render as **hour blocks** at their scheduled time; all-day tasks sit in the all-day lane. Colors follow urgency: red = overdue, blue = today, green = upcoming.

- **Click an empty slot** to schedule a task in it — the time is pre-filled from where you clicked; pick a program, person, and domain and save without leaving the page.
- **Drag a task** to a new day or time to reschedule it; **drag its bottom edge** to change the duration. Dropping a timed task into the all-day lane clears its time. Changes save immediately (and snap back if the save fails).
- You see exactly the tasks for the caseloads you're allowed to see — the same personal lens as the dashboard agenda.

If the installation has Google credentials configured, a **Connect Google Calendar** button appears for users whose account has the calendar opt-in: your tasks then push to your Google calendar (timed ones at their real times) and stay in step as they're edited or deleted. Disconnect any time; without the connection the calendar works exactly the same, just inside CaseLight.

14. Custom forms — the form builder (administrators)

CaseLight is configurable **without code**. Rather than editing the data model, administrators add **custom forms** (attachable to individuals, households, users, or partners) using a drag-and-drop builder under **Manage → Form Builder**.

Choose the record **type**, an optional **frequency**, and — importantly — the form's **sensitivity**:

- **Standard** — any authorized reader of the record.
- **Restricted** — caseload- or role-scoped readers only.
- **Emergency only** — hidden unless a **break-glass** grant is active (see below).

Then drag fields (text, number, date, select, checkbox/radio groups, file upload, text area) into the form. The builder is a **two-pane workspace**: form details on the left, the field stage on the right — and beneath it a **live preview** that renders the *actual* data-entry form staff will see (hit **Refresh preview** as you work; the Preview action on the index shows the same thing for saved forms). A **Duplicate** action clones any of your forms as a "(copy)" starting point. The server accepts only the supported field types, whatever a request claims — the type list above is a contract, not a suggestion. When the organization needs to capture something new, an administrator designs it here — no developer and no database migration required. Household forms appear on the household's **Forms** tab; individual forms on the person's. The [Administrator Guide](#) covers field-design judgment (which widget for which question) in more depth.

15. Security & administration (administrators)

CaseLight surfaces its security posture to the administrators who own it, rather than hiding it in a vendor's data center. The three admin surfaces, in brief — the [Administrator Guide](#) is the full treatment:

Access Review

CaseLight

Ava Adminson
admin

Dashboards

Individuals26

Households10

Partners0

Users6

Manage

Reports

Changelogs

Access Review

Security Enforcement

Access Review

Periodic recertification (AC-2(7)). PER TENANT - run once per subdomain to cover all staff.

Export CSV

NAME	EMAIL	ROLE	LAST SIGN IN	COUNT	MFA	PASSKEYS	LOCKED	DISABLED	CREATED
Ava Adminson	demo.admin@caselight.test	admin	2026-07-30 19:24	242	off	0			2026-07-08
Dev Admin	dev@local.test	admin	2026-07-29 18:14	114	on	1			2026-06-21
Devon Director	demo.director@caselight.test	strategic overviewer	2026-07-30 19:20	12	off	0			2026-07-08
Maria Manders	demo.manager@caselight.test	manager	2026-07-08 17:00	1	off	0			2026-07-08
QA Totp	qa.totp@caselight.test	admin	2026-07-12 09:41	4	on	0			2026-07-11
Wes Worker	demo.worker@caselight.test	case worker	2026-07-30 21:19	22	off	0			2026-07-08

Disabled Staff Still Holding Caseloads

These accounts cannot sign in (disabled) but still have clients assigned. Reassign their caseloads so work is not routed to a dead account.

None — no disabled account holds a caseload.

Least-Privilege Shadow Divergences

AC-6 shadow window (enforcement OFF). How often the narrowed rules WOULD have denied access, per staff member, over the last 14 days. Review before enabling enforcement.

No shadow divergences recorded yet.

Authorization-Cutover Shadow (AC-3)

Global authorization cutover shadow window (enforcement OFF). Actions that WOULD fail the mandatory authorization check, by controller/action/role, over the last 14 days. Review before flipping enforce_authorization.

No authorization-cutover divergences recorded yet.

Access Review (under the main menu) is a periodic account-recertification report: every account with its role, last sign-in, MFA and passkey status, and whether it's locked or disabled. It also flags **disabled staff who still hold caseloads** and summarizes the least-privilege and authorization "shadow" windows. Export it to CSV for your records.

Security Enforcement



Security Enforcement

Runtime control of this organization's Phase-5 security enforcement flags.

Scope: this organization only (cases)

These switches ENABLE or DISABLE live security enforcement for THIS organization. Review the shadow findings below BEFORE enabling. Turning on authorization enforcement makes every action require explicit authorization.

Global authorization enforcement (AC-3)

shadow / off system default

Requires every controller action to explicitly authorize. When enabling, review the authorization-cutover shadow below — any action listed WOULD return 403.

Use system default

Authorization-cutover shadow — would-403, last 14 days (review before enabling)

No shadow divergences recorded yet.

Least-privilege narrowing (AC-6)

shadow / off system default

Scopes progress-note and version reads to need-to-know. When enabling, review the least-privilege shadow below — any row listed WOULD be denied.

Use system default

Least-privilege shadow — would-deny, last 14 days (review before enabling)

No shadow divergences recorded yet.

Tenant-boundary tripwire (SC-7)

ENFORCING persisted override

Refuses any request whose data schema does not match the host tenant. Under normal operation zero mismatches are expected.

Enforcing

0 tenant-mismatch event(s) in the last 14 days (0 expected).

Require two-factor authentication (all users) (IA-2(1))

system default

When On, every signed-in user without 2FA is redirected to enroll before continuing. The default nudges only privileged (admin/manager) accounts. This is an enrollment prompt, never a lockout — the enrollment page and this settings page stay reachable.

Use system default

Idle session timeout (AC-12)

Minutes of inactivity before a session is invalidated and re-authentication is required. Blank uses the system default (30 minutes). Allowed range 1-1440.

Idle timeout (minutes)

System default (30)

Leave blank to use the system default (30).

Account lockout threshold (AC-7)

Consecutive failed sign-ins before an account is locked, and how long until it auto-unlocks. Blank uses the system defaults (10 attempts / 60 minutes).

For safety, the attempt threshold cannot be set below 3 — a lower value could lock out administrators after a couple of typos.

Max failed attempts (minimum 3)

Lockout max attempts

Auto-unlock after (minutes)

Lockout unlock in minutes

Password expiry / rotation (IA-5)

Maximum password age in days. When set, a user whose password is older is prompted to change it at next login (never locked out; the change-password page requires the current password and enforces complexity + no-reuse). Blank means passwords never expire (recommended per NIST 800-63B unless a policy requires rotation).

Max password age (days)

No expiry (default)

Leave blank for no expiry (the default).

Inactive-account auto-disable (AC-2(3))

Days of inactivity (no sign-in) before a staff account is automatically disabled by the daily maintenance run. A disabled account cannot sign in but keeps its records and can be re-enabled from its user page. The last enabled administrator is never auto-disabled. Blank means the daily run only reports would-be candidates and disables nobody.

Disable after inactive (days, minimum 30)

Off — report only (default)

Leave blank to keep auto-disable off (the daily run stays report-only).

Save enforcement settings

Open the full Access Review report

Last changed by dev@local.test at 2026-07-01 11:24

The **Security Enforcement** panel lets an administrator turn live security controls on or off **for their organization** — global authorization enforcement, least-privilege narrowing, the tenant-boundary tripwire, required MFA, idle session timeout, lockout threshold, password expiry, and inactive-account auto-disable — each mapped to a NIST 800-53 control. Each control shows a **shadow window** — what the stricter rule *would* have denied — so you can review the impact before changing it. The three authorization controls are **on by default** in production (since 2026-07-26); your panel settings override the default in either direction, and every change is audited. Requiring MFA follows the enforcement-window practice: turn it on only after your staff have had time to enroll their authentication of choice.

Break-glass emergency access

When a genuine life-safety need requires seeing an **emergency-only** field, an eligible worker can **self-elevate for one hour** — with a **mandatory reason** and the audit record written *first*. Access is scoped to the specific record, expires automatically, and is fully logged.

16. Data protection & privacy

CaseLight is hardened at the application layer toward **NIST 800-53 Moderate** and **SOC 2** (Security, Confidentiality, Privacy), and aligns with the **HIPAA Security Rule**. Highlights:

- **Field-level sensitivity** — Standard / Restricted / Emergency-only on forms and assessment domains; records mask what a role isn't cleared to see.
- **Encryption at rest** — sensitive PII is encrypted in the database across multiple tiers (client names are encrypted in a way that still allows the case-insensitive name search of §6).

- **Append-only audit trail** — record reads and changes are logged to a separate, tenant-isolated store, with change history and retention.
- **Tenant isolation** — each organization is its own subdomain and database schema.
- **Data lifecycle** — retention/deletion routines, guarded and audited deletion, and a **subject-access export** for producing everything held about an individual.

What this means for you day to day: opening a sensitive record is *recorded*, not forbidden — the system's stance is "access with accountability." Break-glass access, record reads on sensitive data, and every change all leave an audit trail with your name on it. That trail is what lets the organization say yes to giving frontline staff real access.

The full compliance package lives in [docs/compliance/](#) — the System Security Plan, SOC 2 control matrix, policies, and a reproducible evidence bundle. Data-handling posture and the production gate for **real** client data are in [../SECURITY.md](#).

Pilot data is synthetic only. Moving to real client records is a deliberate, separate decision that requires meeting the production gate documented in [SECURITY.md](#).

17. Change history

Every record keeps its history:

- **Case history** on an individual's Actions menu shows that record's changes over time — who changed what, when. Households, users, and other record types have the same view.
- **Changelogs** (in the sidebar, for authorized roles) is the organization-wide version: browse recent changes across all record types, filtered by type — the place to answer "what changed yesterday?" without opening records one by one.

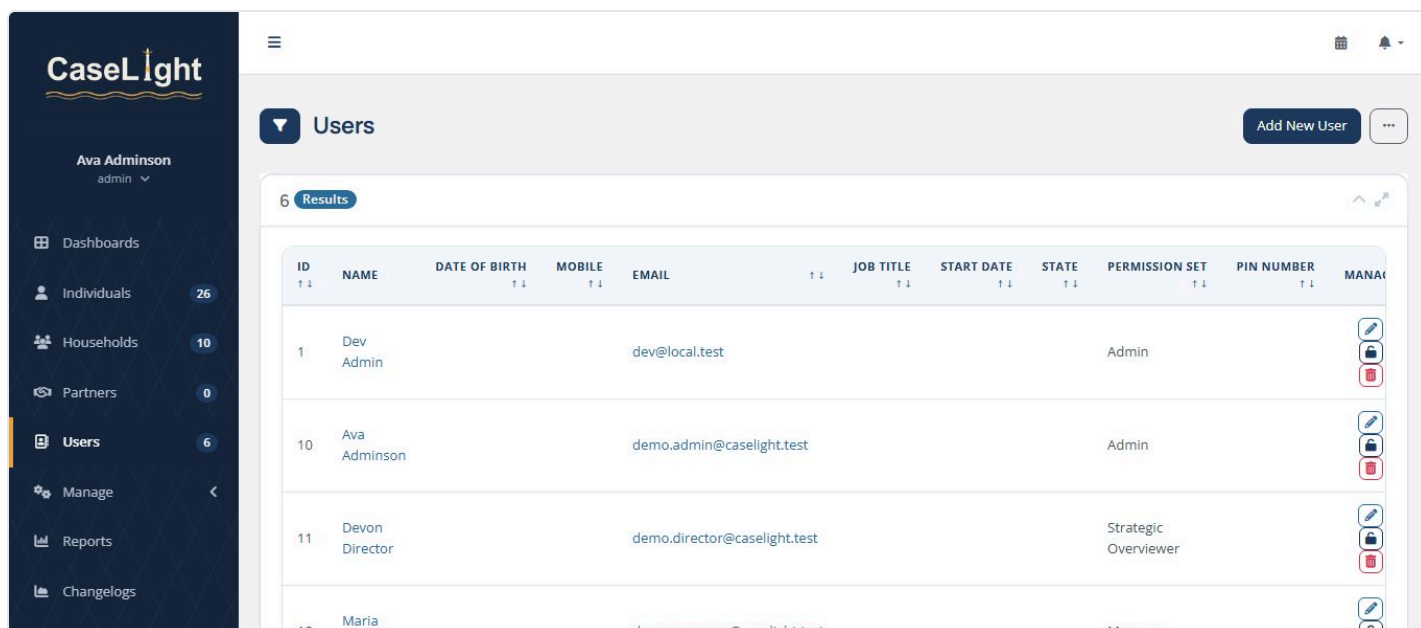
Names and other sensitive values are redacted from history entries by design — the history shows *that* a field changed and who changed it, without duplicating the sensitive value into the history store.

18. Administration reference — the Manage menu

Administrators configure CaseLight from the **Manage** menu (plus **Users** and **Partners**). The form builder ([§14](#)), program streams ([§9](#)), and assessment domains ([§11](#)) are covered above; the remaining items are reference lists that populate dropdowns and organize your work. The [Administrator Guide PDF](#) is the full walkthrough.

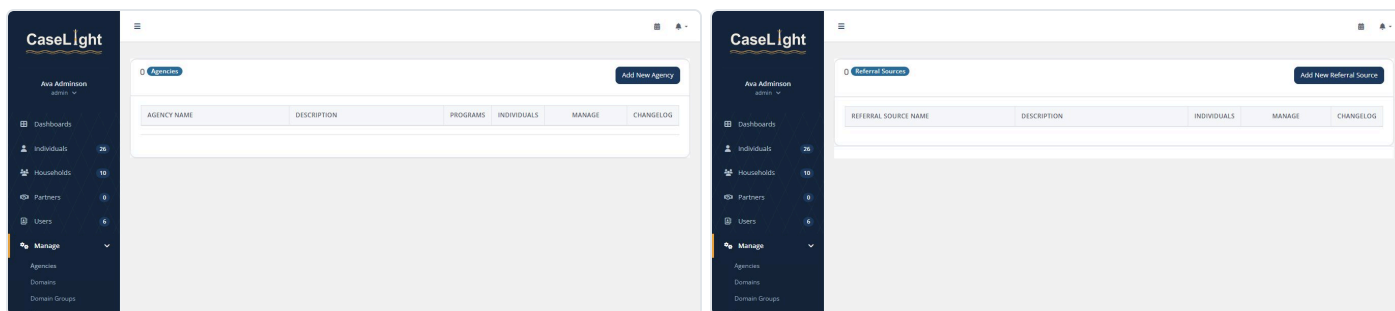
Users

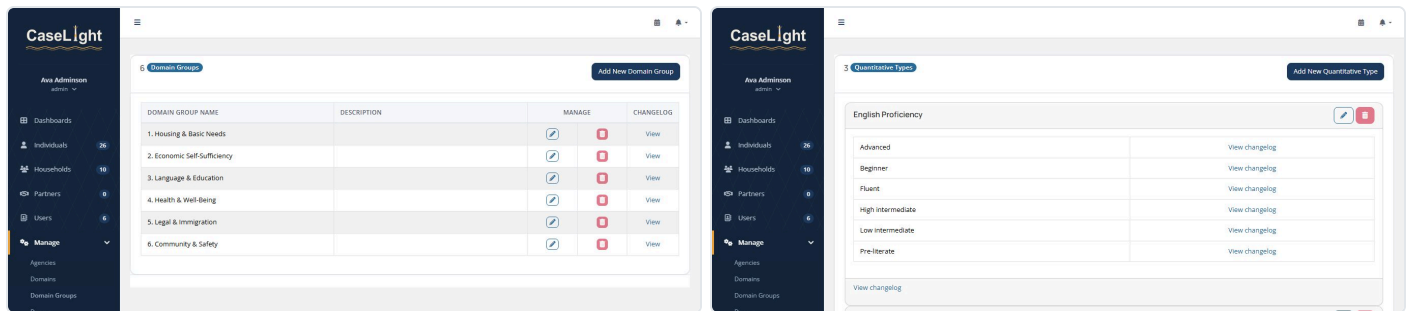
One account per staff member, each with a role. Add users, disable accounts when staff leave (disabling preserves their work history — prefer it over deletion), and export the roster to XLS.



Reference lists

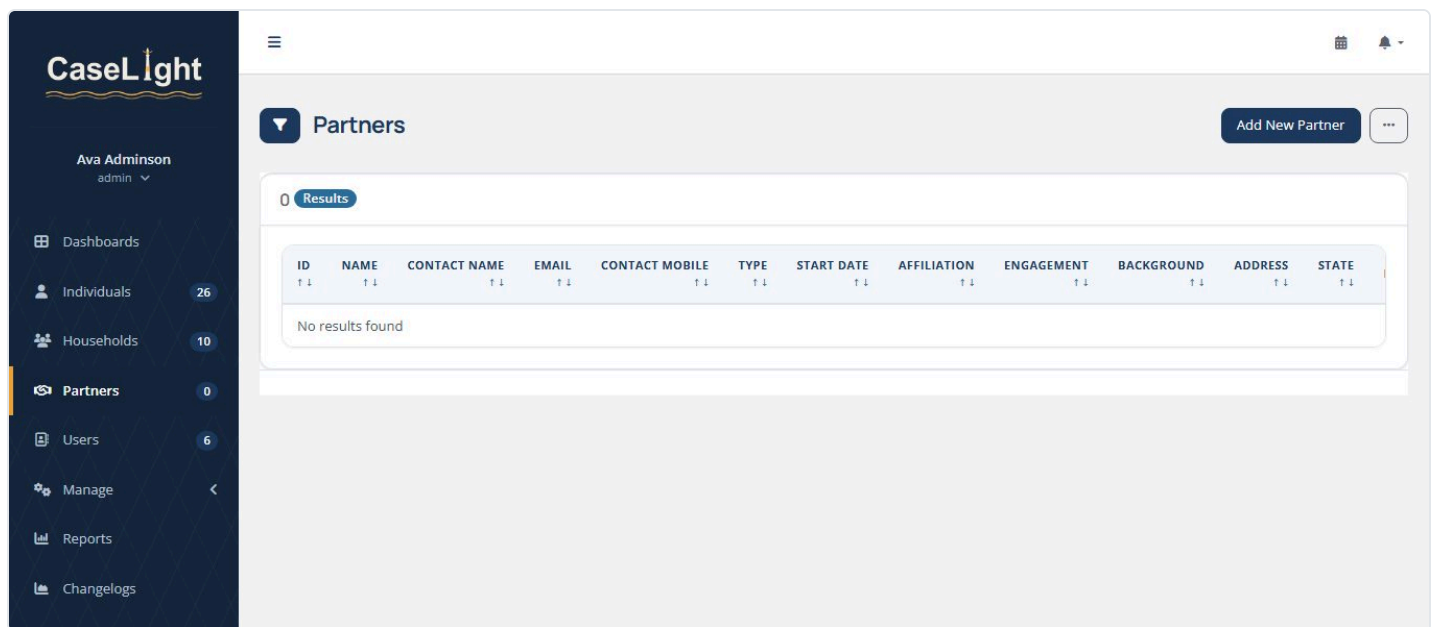
Manage item	What it's for
Agencies	Partner and referring organizations — link each to the programs it works with; the agency's name filters the individuals list to its people
Domain Groups	Grouping for assessment domains
Donors	Funding sources, for reporting
Referral Sources	How clients reach you
Quantitative Types	Reference lists (e.g. English proficiency, income range, benefits enrolled) staff pick from on the individual form — each type is single- or multi-select, with a description shown as help text
Types of Note	Categories for progress notes





Partners

External partner organizations you coordinate with get their own records and custom forms, tracked separately from the individuals you serve.



19. Troubleshooting & FAQ

"My account is locked." Too many failed sign-ins. It unlocks itself after a set interval — wait, then try again (or ask an administrator). If you've lost your MFA device, use a recovery code; if those are gone too, an administrator can help.

"I was forced to change my password." Password expiry is on for your organization. Pick a new one and carry on — nothing is wrong.

"A form shows as a locked row with 'Request access'." The form is marked emergency-only. If you qualify for break-glass access, requesting it grants one hour with a logged reason ([\\$15](#)); otherwise ask the record's manager.

"I can't see a household / individual I expected." Your view is caseload-scoped: case workers see their assigned clients and those clients' households. If someone should be on your caseload, your manager or an administrator assigns them.

"Search doesn't find someone I know exists." Quick search matches whole first or last names — `mar` won't find Maria. Check the spelling, try the other name, or clear any active filter chips under the header. In Advanced Search, an impossible AND (two conditions that can't both be true) returns zero rows — switch to OR or remove a rule.

"An empty section disappeared." Sections with no content start collapsed — click the chevron to expand. The sidebar also collapses itself after you navigate; the menu icon pins it back.

"Editing a program stream warns me about existing enrollments." Changing a program's form affects everyone already enrolled — the warning is asking you to confirm you mean it. When unsure, talk to whoever owns the program's reporting before saving.

20. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Individual	A person you serve (a "client" in older case-management systems).
Household	The family/home unit an individual belongs to; has its own record, forms, notes, and alerts.
Household note	Narrative attached to the whole household rather than one member.
Household alert	A "read first" warning banner on a household, badged onto every member's record; resolved, never deleted.
Program (stream)	An enrollable service with its own enrollment form, trackings, and exit form.
Enrollment	One person's participation in one program, from enroll to exit.
Tracking	A recurring, date-stamped check-in form attached to an enrollment.
Custom form	An admin-designed form attached to a person, household, user, or partner — the no-code way to capture new data.
Entry	One filled-out instance of a custom form (forms can be filled repeatedly).
Assessment	A periodic, scored evaluation across life domains.
Domain / domain group	One assessed life area (Housing, Health...) and the groupings they're organized into.
Case note	A dated narrative entry about work with an individual.
Sensitivity	A field/form/domain classification — Standard, Restricted, or Emergency-only — that gates who sees it.
Break-glass	Reason-required, fully-audited 1-hour self-elevation to see emergency-only data.
Case history / Changelogs	Per-record and organization-wide views of who changed what, when.
Shadow window	A security control running in report-only mode: it records what it <i>would</i> deny, before you enforce it.